

Ashish Vaghela

Full Stack Engineer

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Summary

Full-stack engineer with 2+ years of experience owning products end-to-end, from ambiguous idea to architecture, prototype, and production. Independently built and shipped two production products from scratch (Spring Boot, Kotlin, Java, React) plus a solo-built Android product. Built service monitoring tooling, automated CI/CD workflows, and mentored developers. Thrives with high autonomy, fast iteration, and minimal supervision; strong foundation in TDD, clean code, and API design.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Kotlin, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Backend: Spring Boot, Spring, Quarkus, REST APIs

Frontend: React, Thymeleaf, Jetpack Compose, TailwindCSS, AstroJS

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, H2

DevOps & Automation: Docker, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Git, Linux, VPS deployment

Practices: End-to-end product ownership, rapid prototyping, TDD, clean code, monitoring & reliability, code review, agile, mentoring

Experience

Software Crafter

Nelkinda Software Craft

Sep 2023 – Present

Remote

- Owned the **Triffuns** community-building platform end-to-end: translated business goals into architecture and implementation plans, then built and shipped the product from scratch using **Spring Boot**, Thymeleaf, and TDD
- Built an internal **service monitoring tool** in **Quarkus**, instrumenting services to improve reliability and performance tracking across environments
- Redesigned the application UI for responsiveness and usability, iterating rapidly on real user feedback
- Automated build and deployment workflows with **GitHub Actions** and **Docker**, increasing engineering velocity
- Acted as a developer advocate alongside engineering work: wrote technical blog posts, managed social media presence, and created content to grow product and community visibility

Software Crafter, ChatNCharge (client project)

via Nelkinda Software Craft

Nov 2024 – Present

Remote

- Turned an ambiguous product idea into a working, deployable system: built the **ChatNCharge** product (connecting EV drivers with private and enterprise charging stations) from scratch using **Spring Boot**, owning backend, data model, and APIs
- Validated features through fast iteration with real users and stakeholders, shipping production-grade functionality
- Mentored junior developers and collaborated across design, product, and engineering to ship working solutions

Full Stack Developer Intern

Greycell Labs

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

Ahmedabad, India

- Executed a data migration that significantly improved query performance and data retrieval times
- Shipped UX improvements (persistent user-selected row counts across list pages) and optimized profile-update flows, reducing server load and improving system performance

Projects

Aether Gateway (solo-built, self-hosted LLM gateway)

ashish-codejourney.github.io/aether-gateway

- Built a self-hosted LLM gateway that drops in front of any OpenAI-compatible SDK, handling routing/failover, semantic caching, quota enforcement, and cost accounting transparently
- Implemented circuit breakers/retries/bulkheads across providers (Ollama, Groq, Gemini), a Postgres + pgvector semantic cache for near-duplicate prompts, and per-API-key rate limits enforced atomically before dispatch
- Proved Kubernetes readiness with graceful SSE drain under rolling updates; cut cache-hit latency to 8.9ms p95, reproducible via `make bench`
- **Stack:** Java, Kotlin, PostgreSQL/pgvector, Docker, Kubernetes

MindGuard (solo-built, shipped Android product)

ashish-codejourney.github.io/MindGuard

- Designed, built, and shipped a privacy-first Android app that detects and blocks short-form video feeds to prevent doomscrolling, with no accounts, no tracking, and no servers; owned product, UX, and engineering as a team of one
- **Stack:** Kotlin Multiplatform, Jetpack Compose, Material 3, Coroutines, Flow, DataStore, Koin, Kotlin Test

Open Source & Community

Open Source

- Creator of **satteri-plugins** (github.com/Ashish-CodeJourney/satteri-plugins): npm packages porting popular remark/rehype plugins (slug, autolink headings, KaTeX) to Satteri, the Rust Markdown/MDX engine behind Astro 7. Built as behaviour-compatible replacements, each characterised and tested against the original plugin's output; combined packages see 5k+ weekly downloads on npm
- Contributed to **Zod** (one of the most downloaded packages on npm): github.com/colinhacks/zod/pull/6473
- Active contributor to **MDN Web Docs**: merged pull requests
- Contributor to **Akash Network**: website and awesome-akash pull requests
- Core contributor to **AceUnit** (aceunit.org): a test-discovery unit test framework for C, spanning C89 through C23, hosted and freestanding. Reads the compiled symbol table to find and run tests with no annotations or registration macros, targeting firmware, drivers, and other resource-constrained environments
- Core contributor to **Reqcover** (reqcover.dev): a requirements-coverage tool for JVM tests (Java, Kotlin, Scala, Groovy on JUnit 5). Tags tests with the requirement they verify and fails the build when coverage drops below a configured threshold

Community

- **Maintainer, WeDoTDD.com** (wedotdd.com): help maintain the community-curated directory of companies, teams, and developers practicing disciplined Test-Driven Development and Extreme Programming
- **Core Team Member, Open Source Weekend** (opensourceweekend.org/): Created and maintaining the OSW portal, mentoring new open source contributors and organizing tech meetups

Education

Master of Computer Applications (MCA), Gujarat University, *First Class*

2022 – 2024

Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA), GLS University, *Distinction*

2019 – 2022